

You can flick the screen to go back and forth, pinch and double-tap to zoom, and tap Back to exit.

You can also perform various actions on photos (and on photo thumbnails) using a tap-and-hold method. Flicking over to the center of the Pictures hub display, you'll see that one of your locally-stored photo galleries has been surfaced up for quick access. There's no way to determine which gallery is displayed in this fashion. Instead, Windows Phone picks a gallery randomly. Over at the far right of the Pictures hub is its more enigmatic feature, the What's New section.

This works just like the What's New section in the People hub, but with an important difference. Instead of seeing all of your contacts' social networking updates, this feed presents only those updates that are related to photos. So you will see such things as Facebook and Windows Live-based shared photos, pictures shared on Flickr, and so on, depending on which services you've configured through Windows Live and which accounts you've configured on Windows Phone.

There is one major problem with What's New. While this section does make it easy to find the photos your friends and other contacts have posted online, it doesn't let you view some of them from inside the hub. That is, Windows Live and Facebook-based photos can be viewed normally. But if you click on a photo from Flickr, or some other second tier service (from Windows Phone's perspective), Internet Explorer will load and navigate to the appropriate page on the Web. You can, however, comment on posted photos directly from the What's New section. And that's true of any photo, not just those shared from Windows Live or Facebook.

Find your photos and videos

After you've captured some photos and videos with the phone's camera, you may want to enjoy (or share) them later. Of course, to do so, you'll need to know where to look. Windows Phone stores these pictures in the Pictures hub, in a special folder called Camera Roll. To find this folder, open the Pictures hub and tap the All link. Camera Roll is the first folder shown here, and will be in the top left of this gallery, next to and above other locally stored photos (like Saved Pictures and those photos you've synced from your PC), and above web-based photo folders from Windows Live Photos. If you tap on the Camera Roll thumbnail, you will view the gallery of photos and videos contained within. You can tap on an individual photo or video to view it, or swipe across a photo you're looking at to navigate to the next photo.